

US Department of Agriculture (USDA)



Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan

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Project Name

GMFL SO Janitorial Maintenance Services

Section 1: Introduction

This Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan (QASP) is pursuant to the requirements listed in the performance work statement (PWS) entitled GMFL SO Janitorial Maintenance Services. This plan sets forth the procedures and guidelines that the USDA, USDA Forest Service will use in ensuring the required performance standards or services levels are achieved by the contractor.

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of the QASP is to describe the systematic methods used to measure performance and to identify the reports required and the resources to be employed. The QASP provides a means for evaluating whether the contractor is meeting the performance standards identified in the PWS. This QASP is designed to define roles and responsibilities, identify the performance objectives, define the methodologies used to monitor and evaluate the contractor's performance, describe quality assurance reporting, and describe the analysis of quality assurance monitoring results.

1.2 QASP Relation to the Contract

1.2.1 QASP Revisions

The Contracting Officer Representative (COR) may make revisions or changes to the QASP procedures and surveillance methods or increase or decrease the degree of surveillance methods at any time during the contract performance period. Changes to the Metric must be incorporated into the PWS, Performance Requirement Summary (PRS) and QASP by a bilateral modification to contract that is issued by the Contracting Officer (CO). A copy of the QASP is provided to the contractor to enable the contractor to enhance its Quality Control (QC) program to perform in accordance with its Quality Control Plan (QCP).

1.2.2 Surveillance of Performance Progression

As the performance period progresses, the levels of surveillance may be altered for service areas where performance is either consistently excellent or unsatisfactory. If consistently good performance, then the amount of surveillance may be reduced. If observations reveal consistent deficiencies, increased surveillance may be implemented.

1.3 QASP Relation to the Quality Control Plan (QCP)

The QCP is a required element of contract and the Contractor shall adhere to its established quality control processes and procedures in managing and performing work as described in the contract. While the QCP represents the way in which the Contractor will ensure its quality and timeliness of services, as defined in the PWS, the QASP represents the way in which the Government personnel specified in *Section 3: Contractor and Government Responsibilities, Paragraph 3.2, Government Responsibilities* will evaluate the contractor's performance. The contractor's QC program and the residual organization's QASP should be complementary programs that ensure successful contractor performance.

Section 2: Performance Description

Performance of the contractor will be monitored through the surveillance methods described in Section 4: Surveillance Methods to Perform Quality Assurance to assess the Contractor's performance against PWS requirements.

2.1 Performance Standards and Acceptable Quality Levels (AQLs)

For selected activities in the PWS, the PRS provides a performance standard and an AQL. A performance standard is the expected level of contractor performance. An AQL defines the level of performance that is satisfactory. Depending on the service evaluated and the evaluation method selected, performance standards and AQLs may be stated as a number of occurrences or as a percentage. Performance standards and AQLs for random sampling and 100 percent inspection are generally stated as percentages. For periodic inspections, performance standards may be stated as either percentages or as absolute numbers.

The contract requires the Contractor to perform all work as specified. Any inaccuracies or omissions in services or products are referred to as "defects" on the part of the Contractor. The Contractor shall be responsible for all identified

defects and may be required to perform the work at no cost to the government. The AQLs take into account that in some instances an allowable level of deficiencies (deviations) is possible while overall performance continues to meet the government's desired level of service.

2.1.1 Allowable Deviation

The AQLs define the level or number of performance deficiencies the Contractor is permitted to reach under this contract. AQLs take into account the difference between an occasional defect and a gross number of defects. AQLs can be expressed as a percentage of or as an absolute number (e.g., three per month). There may be instances where 100 percent compliance is required, and no deviation is acceptable (e.g., where safety is involved).

2.1.2 Substantially Complete

In some cases, service outputs are evaluated using subjective values (e.g., excellent, satisfactory, unsatisfactory). The criteria for acceptable performance and for defects must be defined for these service outputs. The concept of "substantially complete" should be the basis for inspections based on subjective scales. Work is considered "substantially complete" where there has been no significant departure from the terms of the contract and no omission of essential work. In addition, the Contractor has performed the work required to the best of its ability and the only variance consists of minor omissions or deficiencies.

2.2 Non-Performance

Non-performance occurs when the contractor's performance does not meet the AQL for a given requirement. Requirements may contain multiple performance elements, and therefore, deficiencies may occur in one or more aspects of performance (e.g., timeliness, accuracy, completeness, etc.) or subject areas of effort.

When surveillance indicates that the contractor's service output is not in compliance with the contract requirements, the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) must determine whether the Contractor or the Government caused the deficiency. If the cause of the defect rests with the Government, corrective action must be taken through Government channels. If the cause of the defect is due to action or inaction by the contractor, the contractor is responsible for correction of the problem at no additional expense to the Government.

2.2.1 Documentation

Documentation of work non-performed or unacceptable work is essential for tracking Contractor performance. The COR will document deficient work by compiling facts describing the inspection methods and results and to substantiate nonconformance with the contract. The documentation, with any recommendations, will be forwarded to the CO. In the case of the Contractor, the COR will decide whether to elevate the problem to the CO for corrective action.

2.2.2 Remedial Actions

The Federal Acquisition Regulation allows for penalties in the event that the Contractor fails to perform the required services. Penalties are defined as those actions taken under the direction of the CO against the contractor within the general provisions of the contract for nonconformance to the PWS and PRS.

Section 3: Contractor and Government Responsibilities

3.1 Contractor Responsibility

The Contractor is responsible for delivering products or services in accordance with the contract. Implementing its QCP, which describes the Contractor's methods for ensuring all products and services under the contract meet established performance standards and AQLs. Maintaining, and providing for audit, quality control records and reports and all records associated with the investigation and complaint resolutions. Appointing a single quality control point-of-contact to act as a central recipient of communication from the COR or CO.

3.2 Government Responsibility

3.2.1 Contracting Officer (CO)

The CO is responsible for administering and monitoring contract compliance, contract administration, and cost control and for resolving any differences between the observations documented by COR and the contractor's performance. The CO may delegate various day-to-day contract administration duties to a Administering ACO (ACO) and/or the COR for performance management and administrative actions such as invoice approval and issuance of Contract Discrepancy Reports may be, and normally are, delegated by the CO to the COR. The CO shall approve any revisions to the QASP processes or standards.

3.2.2 Contracting Officer Representative (COR)

The COR, is designated in writing, by the CO. The COR will ensure that the QA function is properly executed, plays a key role in contract administration and performs the contract surveillance and monitoring. Some key contract administration duties include, but are not limited to, performs surveillance as required by this QASP; make recommendations to the CO for issuance of Contract Discrepancy Reports or letters of commendation and acceptance or rejection of completed work and for administrative actions based on unsatisfactory or non-performed work, and revisions or changes to the QASP; and assists the CO in identifying necessary contract modifications and preparing reports of Contractor performance and cost.

The COR may use the form(s) included in the Appendices to perform the inspection or other forms as approved by the CO.

3.2.3 Customers

Customers or organizations/offices that the Contractor provided support may be requested to assist the COR in conducting QA to provide information relating to the Contractor's performance through Customer Feedback. Information gained from the Customer Feedback may be used in conjunction with other methods of observation to rate the performance of the Contractor.

Section 4: Surveillance Methods to Perform Quality Assurance

4.1 Surveillance Methods

The surveillance methods used in the QA process are the Government's tools to monitor the Contractor's products and services. The best means of determining whether the Contractor has met all contract requirements is to inspect the Contractor's service products and analyze the results. Further, documented inspection results are an effective tool in contract administration that can confirm the successful achievement of all performance requirements or highlight areas where defects exist and improvements are necessary.

4.2 Analysis and Results

When the inspections and customer feedback validations have been completed, the COR will perform an analysis of the Contractor's performance. The purpose of the analysis is to ensure Government is receiving high-quality products and services from the Contractor. The COR will review the results, rate the Contractor's compliance with the performance standards and AQLs, and characterize the Contractor's overall performance. Analysis of all types of contract monitoring will result in one of the following outcomes:

Clean and sanitary facilities for the safety and well-being of the employees and visitors at the GMFL SO site.

PERFORMANCE REQUIREMENT SUMMARY

Required Services (PWS Task)	Performance Standard	Acceptable Quality Level (AQL)	Method of Surveillance
<i>Key Deliverable 1: Supervisors Office basic services</i>	<i>Services two times weekly</i>	<i>90%</i>	<i>Periodic inspections, random observations, customer complaints</i>
<i>Key Deliverable 2: Supervisors Office Deep/Intensive Cleaning</i>	<i>Services two times Yearly</i>	<i>90%</i>	<i>Periodic inspections, random observations, customer complaints</i>

Basic Cleaning Services (Twice Weekly):

1. Visitor Areas, Office Surfaces and Conference Rooms

- Clean and sanitize countertops and tables.
- Clean interior and exterior glass at main employee and visitor entrances.

2. Floor Maintenance

- Sweep, dust mop, damp mop, wet mop, and vacuum all hard floors and carpets.
- Dry buff and spray buff as needed.
- Move chairs and receptacles as needed to clean under them and return to original position.
- Ensure all floor surfaces, including corners, are free of dirt, litter, dust, and debris.

3. Kitchens and Break Rooms

- Clean inside and outside of all appliances.
- Clean flat surfaces, windows, sinks, cupboards, chairs, and tables.
- Disinfect tables and counters.
- Clean stainless steel appliances using appropriate products.

4. High-Touch Surfaces

- Clean and disinfect switches, chairs, tables, counters, windows, door handles, knobs, and toilet levers.
- Use EPA-approved disinfectants or 70% alcohol solution.

5. Trash and Recycling Removal

- Empty all trash and recycling in offices, restrooms, and feminine hygiene receptacles.
- Replace liners when soiled.
- Deposit waste in exterior dumpsters and recycling bins.
- Keep receptacles free of odors, dirt, and debris inside and out.

6. Drinking Fountains and Faucets

- Clean and disinfect drinking fountains and faucets.
- Ensure porcelain and metal surfaces are free of streaks, smudges, and scale.

7. Stairs

- Clean floors and railings; remove dirt, debris, scuff marks, and spots.
- Disinfect railings.

8. Entrances, Corridors, Lobbies and Conference Rooms

- Remove cobwebs, debris, odors, and visible dirt.
- Keep glass free of smudges, film, streaks, and spots.

9. Bathrooms and Shower

- Damp clean and disinfect all bathroom surfaces.
- Clean toilet bowls (interior and exterior), seats, stems, sinks.
- Remove stains, residue, odors; sweep and mop floors.

10. Restroom Resupply

- Replenish contractor-supplied toilet paper, paper towels, soap, and feminine hygiene products.
- Disinfect handles and porcelain surfaces.
- Ensure supply cabinets are stocked each cleaning.
- Maintain restroom dispensers in working order.

Deep Cleaning Services (Twice Annually)

1. Windows and Blinds

- Clean interior and exterior window glass.
- Clean windowsills, casings, frames, and jambs.
- Rinse screens; remove dust and debris.
- Clean/dust blinds.

2. Floor Treatments

- Apply sealant to ceramic and stone floor grout.
- Wax and buff tile and vinyl floors.
- Shampoo carpets and rugs.

3. Detailed Dusting and Cleaning

- Clean all door surfaces, frames, baseboards, ducts, molding, wall fixtures, pictures, and vents.
- Clean ceiling lights and remove insects, dust, and debris.
- Tops of office dividers, fire hydrants cases and pulls.

4. Grout Care

- Clean grout with grout cleaner.
- Apply grout sealant.

5. Entrance Walk-Off Mats

- Clean recessed walk-off mats; remove all dirt and debris on and around the mats.

Appendix B: Example Discrepancy Report

The following document is only an example, which is not all inclusive, that can be revised and used, if applicable, in the QASP as attachments or exhibits.

DISCREPANCY REPORT			1. DISCREPANCY REPORT NO.
2. TO: (Contractor / Project Manager Name)		3. FROM: (Name of COR)	
CONTRACT NUMBER:		DATE:	
PREPARED	ORAL NOTIFICATION	RETURNED BY CONTRACTOR	ACTION COMPLETE
4. DISCREPANCY OR PROBLEM (Describe in Detail. Include PWS references. Attach Continuation Sheet if Necessary)			
5. SIGNATURE OF COR			
6. TO: (Name of COR)		7. FROM: (Contractor / Project Manager)	
8. CONTRACTOR RESPONSE AS TO CAUSE, EFFECT, CORRECTIVE ACTION AND ACTIONS TO PREVENT RECURRENCE (Attach Continuation Sheet if necessary. Cite applicable Contractor QC program procedures or new QC procedures)			
9. SIGNATURE OF CONTRACTOR REPRESENTATIVE		10. DATE	
11. GOVERNMENT EVALUATION (Acceptance, partial acceptance, or rejection. Attach Coordination Sheet if necessary)			
12. GOVERNMENT ACTIONS (Cure notice, show cause, other)			
CLOSE OUT			
KTR NOTIFIED	NAME AND TITLE	SIGNATURE	DATE
COR			

Appendix C: Customer Feedback Record

The following document is only an example, which is not all inclusive, that can be revised and used, if applicable, in the QASP as attachments or exhibits.

CUSTOMER FEEDBACK RECORD	
DATE AND TIME OF COMPLAINT	CONTRACT NUMBER/ OR PROJECT:
SOURCE OF COMPLAINT	
ORGANIZATION	
INDIVIDUAL	
NATURE OF COMPLAINT	
PWS REFERENCE	
VALIDATION	
DATE AND TIME CONTRACTOR INFORMED OF COMPLAINT	NAME OF CONTRACTOR REPRESENTATIVE INFORMED OF COMPLAINT
ACTION TAKEN BY CONTRACTOR (Responsible officer):	
RECEIVED AND VALIDATED BY	
Determination: Complaint Valid ☐ Complaint Invalid ☐	

Appendix D: Example Guide / Inspection List

The following document is only an example, which is not all inclusive, that can be revised and used, if applicable, in the QASP as attachments or exhibits.

CONTRACT NUMBER: _____

SERVICE FUNCTION: _____

PWS SECTION: _____

1	Method of Surveillance:			
2	Lot Size:			
3	Sample Size:			
4	Performance Requirement: Performance is Excellent (E) when _____ or fewer defects are discovered per month. Performance is Satisfactory (S) when _____ or fewer defects are discovered per month. Performance is Unsatisfactory (U) when _____ or more defects are discovered per month.			
5	Sampling Procedure: Instructions on how to select the sample must be clear and complete			
6	Inspection Procedure: The procedure must be detailed enough to allow a yes/no objective decision as to the acceptability of performance by anyone making the inspection. Explain when evaluation is to occur and what is acceptable/unacceptable			
		Performance: Excellent (E), Satisfactory (S), Unsatisfactory (U), Not Applicable (N/A)		
	PRS Requirements	Timeliness	Quality of Work	Notes
	Overall Rating Of Inspection (E, S, U or N/A)			

COR/Inspector Comments: _____

Contractor Signature: _____ Date: _____

COR Signature: _____ Date: _____

Appendix E: Example Quality Assurance Monitoring

The following document is only an example, which is not all inclusive, that can be revised and used, if applicable, in the QASP as attachments or exhibits.

CONTRACT NUMBER: _____

SERVICE or STANDARD: _____

SURVEY PERIOD: _____

SURVEILLANCE METHOD (*Check the applicable item*):

☐ Random Sampling ☐ 100% Inspection ☐ Periodic Inspection ☐ Customer Complaint

LEVEL OF SURVEILLANCE (*Check the applicable item*):

☐ Monthly ☐ Quarterly ☐ As needed

PERCENTAGE OF ITEMS SAMPLED DURING SURVEY PERIOD: _____ %

ANALYSIS OF RESULTS:

Observed Service Provider Performance Measurement Rate: _____ %

Service Provider's Performance (*Check the applicable item*):

☐ Meets Standards

☐ Does Not Meet Standards

Narrative of Performance During Survey Period: _____

Prepared By: _____

Date: _____

Appendix F: Example Customer Complaint Investigation

The following document is only an example, which is not all inclusive, that can be revised and used, if applicable, in the QASP as attachments or exhibits.

CONTRACT NUMBER: _____

SERVICE or STANDARD:

SURVEY PERIOD: _____

DATE COMPLAINT RECEIVED: _____

SOURCE OF COMPLAINT: _____ (Name)

_____ (Organization)

_____ (Phone No.) _____ (Email Address)

NATURE OF COMPLAINT:

RESULTS OF COMPLAINT INVESTIGATION:

DATE SERVICE PROVIDER INFORMED OF COMPLAINT: _____

CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN BY SERVICE PROVIDER:

Received and Validated By: _____

Prepared By: _____ Date: _____

Appendix G: Example Surveillance Activity Checklist

The following document is only an example, which is not all inclusive, that can be revised and used, if applicable, in the QASP as attachments or exhibits.

Performance Requirement	Performance Standard	Method of Measurement	Performance Metrics	Method of Surveillance	Date Accomplished	Compliance (Exceed, Met, Partial Met)